

CONNOISSEUR'S CHOICE

TEXT & PHOTOGRAPHS BY **BANDEEP SINGH**

MODEL EMILLY DE CASTRO/ OPAL MODELS
MAKE UP SUJEET KUMAR • **HAIR** MATEEN AHMAD

Equipoise in Stone

'Balance' Console by Rooshad Shroff

The form of round river stones playfully stacked on top of each other forms the design language of Rooshad Shroff's new collection, 'Balance'. The designer, known for his stone inlay furniture—and who has carved marble lamps and created carnival-spirited window displays for Hermès showrooms—expanded upon the creative inspiration behind a 2021 marble side-table to create a line of furniture and accessories that were unveiled at an exhibition in Mumbai this October. The centrepiece of the show was an ovoid console with a 5 ft by 2 ft green onyx slab resting on an underlay of cast bronze, tantalisingly balanced on an asymmetrical stack of two marble orbs held by a cuboid base. The heavy top pivoted on the small ellipsoid creates a substantial overhang on both sides. The complex simplicity of the 300 kg piece—at once serene yet imbued with intricate structural physics—evokes a meditative zen stillness and a feeling of equipoise. Shroff, however, does not usurp the philosophical interpretations of the remarkable piece; instead, he attributes the inspiration to his interest in cantilevers and suspension architecture. Priced at ₹25 lakh, this striking piece of collectible design takes about 8 to 10 artisans, four months to craft. In the end, it is quite a balanced worth!

